AVARA KASA WUI KHARARCHAN: THE BOOK OF GENESIS IN TANGKH

The Book of Genesis in Tangkhul Naga

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PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

The Book of Genesis (Avara Kasa wui Khararchan) establishes the foundational cosmogony of the Tangkhul Bible. Translated and refined across successive generations by native scholars and the Bible Society of India, it bridges ancient Semitic narratives with the rich ecological and agrarian vocabulary of the Naga hills.

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CHAPTER 1: THE CREATION OF THE WORLD (GENESIS 1)

Summary: The six days of creation and the Sabbath rest in grand ceremonial Tangkhul dicti...

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis 1:1-5, 26-27: Kaphung-kachungwui thotli Varivarana kazing kala ngalei sakahaisai. Kala ngalei chi kasham eina khangari-leilakha leisai, kala ngaching china kapei ngashakazilli chumpamsai; kala Varivarawui Mangazingna tui-ngapomli ngazuklaga pamye. Chitharan Varivarana hang: ’Mangashan shokru!’ Kala mangashan shokserie. Kala Varivarana mangashan kapha chi theitserie, kala mangashan kala ngachingli kashit-eina pamsakserie. ...Kala Varivarana hang: ’Ithuwui mai thada, ithuwui katha eina mikumoli saru; athumna ngashakazilwui ngachayei, kazingramwui vanao, kala ngaleiwui saphang kuppupli ngashankasarap sara.’ Hithada Varivarana Awui mai thada mikumoli sakahaisai; mayarnaowon kala ngalanaowon eina sakahaisai.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth. And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters. And God said, Let there be light: and there was light. And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness. ...And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth. So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** sakahaisai (verb): created / made definitively**

Ex: Varivarana sakahaisai.

*** ngazuklaga (verb): hovering, brooding over gently**

Ex: Tui-ngapomli ngazuklaga.

*** saphang (noun): beasts of the earth, animal kingdom**

Ex: Ngaleiwui saphang.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Divine fiat imperative formula: 'shokru!' (Let there be!).
- Gender pair nominalization: 'mayarnaowon kala ngalanaowon' (male and female).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Analyze the descriptive formula for the primeval void.

[?] How does Genesis 1:26 express human stewardship over nature in Tangkhul?

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: THE GARDEN OF EDEN & THE TREE OF LIFE (GENESIS 2-3)

Summary: The planting of Eden, the two sacred trees, and the covenant of moral responsibi...

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis 2:8-9, 3:1-6: Kala Proho Varivarana kashong-zingsho eina Edenli luiram akha shansangie; kala Ana sakahai mikumoli chithuili pamsakserie. Kala Proho Varivarana ngalei eina thingphun kathata mathathei-kapha kala kashak-kapha pamei phokrarsakserie; luiram ngalungli ringkaphavai thingphun kala kapha-kashili theikhavai thingphun leisai. ...Kha phar china Proho Varivarana sakahai ngaleiwui saphang kuppup eina chashak-kapha pameisai; ana shanaoli hang: 'Varivarana luiramwui thingthei kachikhali mashak-alu hoda hung-kachak lei-macho?'

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

And the LORD God planted a garden eastward in Eden; and there he put the man whom he had formed. And out of the ground made the LORD God to grow every tree that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food; the tree of life also in the midst of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and evil. ...Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** luiram (noun): orchard, terraced garden, cultivated grove**

Ex: Edenli luiram akha.

*** thingphun (noun): standing tree, living botanical arbor**

Ex: Ringkaphavai thingphun.

*** chashak-kapha (adj): cunning, subtle, crafty**

Ex: Phar china chashak-kapha.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Agrarian botanical compound: 'luiram' (field/orchard land).
- Negative interrogative particle: 'lei-macho?' (is it indeed so?).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Compare the Tangkhul names for the Tree of Life and Tree of Knowledge.

[?] Identify the role of 'phar' (serpent) in traditional Naga folklore vs Genesis.

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 3: NOAH’S ARK & THE RAINBOW COVENANT (GENESIS 6-9)

Summary: The construction of the giant wooden vessel, the deluge, and the rainbow token o...

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis 6:14, 9:12-16: ’Nawui vang gopher thing eina kuphung kashang akha salu; kuphungli shimsak salaga, kuphung kashikli kala kaphungli dhar eina hulup-khalaplu.’ ...Varivarana hang: ’Iwui kala nathumwui ngachaili ... thot pupupwui vang I sakahai tui-ngashikwui theichitheina hi: I Kazing-ngachamli Iwui Mayangwon (Rainbow) sangkahaye; kala chiya Iwui kala ngaleiwui ngachaili tui-ngashikwui theichithei sara. Kala I mayangwon theirarlaga mikumo kala ringkapha saphang pupupli thikhavai kasham tuikhangahui masaralu.’

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Make thee an ark of gopher wood; rooms shalt thou make in the ark, and shalt pitch it within and without with pitch. ...And God said, This is the token of the covenant which I make between me and you and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations: I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth. And I will remember my covenant, that the waters shall no more become a flood to destroy all flesh.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** Mayangwon (noun): rainbow, celestial arch of flowers/colors**

Ex: Kazing-ngachamli Mayangwon.

*** tui-ngashik (noun): covenant, sacred treaty, binding pact**

Ex: Tui-ngashikwui theichithei.

*** tuikhangahui (noun): great flood, deluge, catastrophic inundation**

Ex: Kasham tuikhangahui.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Poetic cultural compound: 'Mayangwon' (lit. bloom/arch of the skies).
- Perpetual covenant marker: 'thot pupupwui vang' (for all generations).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Describe how 'covenant' (tui-ngashik) parallels traditional Tangkhul peace oaths.

[?] What is the literal meaning of 'Mayangwon'?

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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CHAPTER 4: THE CALL OF ABRAHAM & THE COVENANT OF FAITH (GENESIS 12 & 15)

Summary: Abraham’s departure from Ur and the promise of descendants numerous as the stars...

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis 12:1-3, 15:5: Prohona Abramli hang: ’Nawui ram, nawui shimanwui ngalung, kala nawui avashim eina shoklaga, I chitheikhavai ramli valoo! Kala I nawui eina ngashan kashang akha sarap sara, kala I nawui phasan milu sara... kala nawui ming eina ngaleiwui ngashan pupupna mathasek-u sara.’ ...Ana Abramli kaphung eina yangsaklaga hang: ’Kazingli yanglu, sirabingli kharep-shukralang khareplu!’ Kala Ana hang: ’Nawui ngashan chi hithada sara.’ Kala Abramna Proholi chotkhangashit khuiye; kala chiya awui mashung-kasa hoda hisangmi.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father’s house, unto a land that I will shew thee: And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing: And in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed. ...And he brought him forth abroad, and said, Look now toward heaven, and tell the stars, if thou be able to number them: and he said unto him, So shall thy seed be. And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** avashim (noun): father’s house, patrilineal clan homestead**

Ex: Nawui avashim eina.

*** sira (noun): star, celestial body**

Ex: Sirabingli kharep.

*** chotkhangashit (noun/verb): faith, to believe unwaveringly**

Ex: Proholi chotkhangashit.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Direct imperative departure form: ’valoo!’ (Go forth!).
- Patrilineal kinship terminology: ’avashim’ reflects native clan organization.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Analyze the count noun ’sirabing’ (stars).

[?] Explain the Tangkhul rendering of Genesis 15:6 (’counted for righteousness’).

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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CHAPTER 5: JOSEPH AND HIS BROTHERS IN EGYPT (GENESIS 37 & 45)

Summary: The coat of many colors, the descent into Egypt, and the reconciliation of Josep...

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis 37:3, 45:3-5: Israelna Josephli azao-azana tharili pamei ngayeiye; kala ana awui vang kachon kakhangatei kapha akha sakahaisai. ...Josephna awui uningnaobingli hang: 'I Joseph-sai! I-ava ring-leirang-macho?' Kha uningnaobingna awui ngalemli ngachek-kashung thotlaga ngahan-mashuk-mana. Kala Josephna hang: 'I ngalemli rarlaklu... nathumna ili hili pashitsang-kaji vang ningkasham makasaloo: kasakei mikumowui ringkaphavai huikhuikhavai Varivarana ili nathumwui mik-ngalemli kashokahaisaye!'

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Now Israel loved Joseph more than all his children, because he was the son of his old age: and he made him a coat of many colours. ...And Joseph said unto his brethren, I am Joseph; doth my father yet live? And his brethren could not answer him; for they were troubled at his presence. And Joseph said unto his brethren, Come near to me, I pray you... Now therefore be not grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that ye sold me hither: for God did send me before you to preserve life.

CHAPTER 5 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** uningnaobing (noun): brothers, sibling clan members**

Ex: Awui uningnaobingli hang.

*** pashitsang (verb): sold into bondage / bartered away**

Ex: Ili hili pashitsang.

*** ningkasham (noun): sorrow, inner anguish, bitter grief**

Ex: Ningkasham makasaloo.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Prohibitive emotional phrase: 'ningkasham makasaloo' (Do not make grief of heart).
- Sibling collective plural: 'uningnaobing' (older and younger brothers).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Discuss the emotional vocabulary in Joseph's reconciliation speech.

[?] How does the concept of divine providence surface in Genesis 45:5?

CHAPTER 5 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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CHAPTER 6: COMPREHENSIVE PATRIARCHAL LEXICON OF GENESIS

Summary: Key geographical, tribal, and creation terms recorded in the Tangkhul Genesis....

Tangkhul Text:

Genesis Tuitam Lexicon:
1. Kaphung-kachung -- Primeval beginning
2. Luiram -- Cultivated garden / orchard
3. Thingphun -- Tree of life
4. Mayangwon -- Rainbow token of peace
5. Tui-ngashik -- Covenant pact
6. Tuikhangahui -- Deluge / Great Flood
7. Avashim -- Ancestral patrilineal home
8. Sira -- Stars of the sky

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

A glossary of cosmological, familial, and agrarian terms from the Book of Genesis.

CHAPTER 6 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** tui-ngashik (noun): covenant**

Ex: Tui-ngashik kasa.

*** luiram (noun): garden**

Ex: Eden luiram.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Nominal composition using ’-ram’ (land/territory).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Form five sentences using Genesis cosmological nouns.

CHAPTER 6 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* sakahaisai -- created / made definitively
* ngazuklaga -- hovering, brooding over gently
* saphang -- beasts of the earth, animal kingdom
* luiram -- orchard, terraced garden, cultivated grove
* thingphun -- standing tree, living botanical arbor
* chashak-kapha -- cunning, subtle, crafty
* Mayangwon -- rainbow, celestial arch of flowers/colors
* tui-ngashik -- covenant, sacred treaty, binding pact

Digitization Colophon:

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